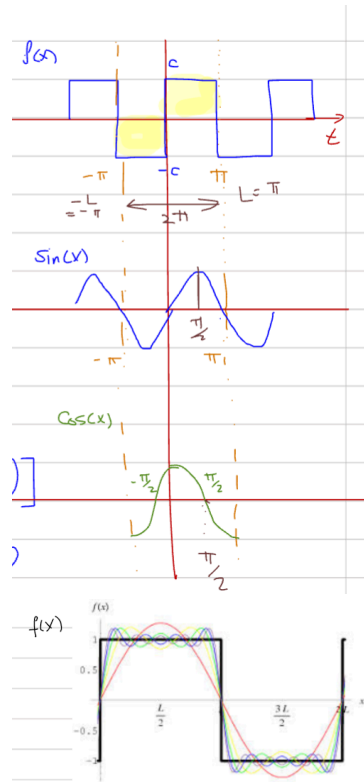


4 - Physical Layer Notes

Fourier Series Representation



The Fourier series is used to represent signals in the physical layer. The general representation of a function $f(x)$ is defined as:

- $$f(x) = a_0 + \sum_{n=1}^N \left[a_n \cos\left(\frac{n\pi}{L}x\right) + b_n \sin\left(\frac{n\pi}{L}x\right) \right]$$

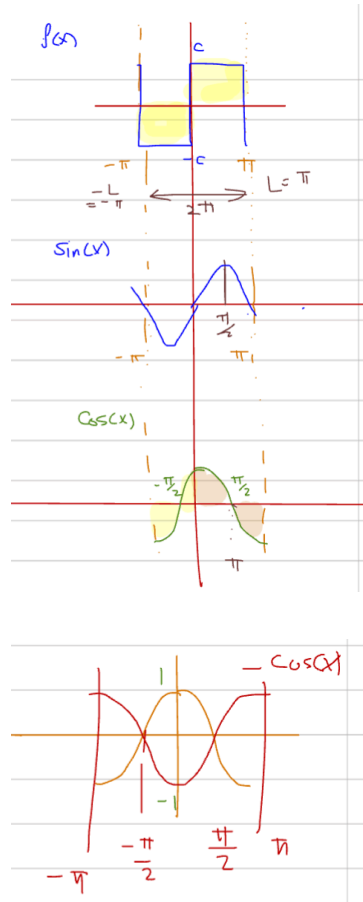
When the period is $P = 2L$, the coefficients are calculated as follows:

- $$a_0 = \frac{1}{2L} \int_{-L}^L f(x) dx$$
- $$a_n = \left(\frac{1}{L}\right) \int_{-L}^L f(x) \cos\left(\frac{n\pi}{L}x\right) dx$$
- $$b_n = \frac{1}{L} \int_{-L}^L f(x) \sin\left(\frac{n\pi}{L}x\right) dx$$

Square Wave Function and Fourier Approximation

Example 1: Square Wave Function

Problem: Find the Fourier series coefficients for a square wave function with period $P = 2\pi$ (where $L = \pi$).



Answer:

Finding a_1 :

$$a_1 = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} f(x) \cos(x) dx = \frac{1}{\pi} \left[\int_{-\pi}^0 (-c) \cos(x) dx + \int_0^{\pi} c \cos(x) dx \right] \quad (\text{Split intervals}) = \frac{1}{\pi} \left[-c \int_{-\pi}^0 \cos(x) dx + c \int_0^{\pi} \cos(x) dx \right]$$

Result: $a_1 = 0$ (All a_n coefficients are 0 due to odd symmetry)

Finding b_1 :

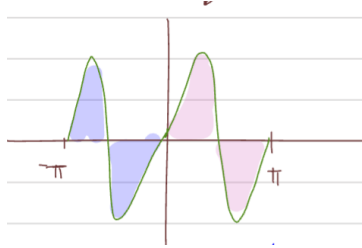
$$b_1 = \frac{1}{\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} f(x) \sin(x) dx = \frac{1}{\pi} \left[\int_{-\pi}^0 (-c) \sin(x) dx + \int_0^{\pi} c \sin(x) dx \right] \quad (\text{Split intervals}) = \frac{1}{\pi} \left[(-c) [-\cos(x)]_0^0 + c [-\cos(x)]_0^{\pi} \right]$$

Result: $b_1 = \frac{4c}{\pi}$

Finding b_2 :

$$b_2 = \frac{1}{\pi} \left[\int_{-\pi}^0 (-c) \sin(2x) dx + \int_0^{\pi} c \sin(2x) dx \right] = \frac{1}{\pi} \left[(-c) \left(-\frac{1}{2} \right) [\cos(2x)]_{-\pi}^0 + c \left(-\frac{1}{2} \right) [\cos(2x)]_0^{\pi} \right] \quad (\text{Integrating})$$

 **Result:** $b_2 = 0$ (All even harmonics are 0)



Finding b_3 :

$$b_3 = \frac{1}{\pi} \left[\int_{-\pi}^0 (-c) \sin(3x) dx + \int_0^{\pi} c \sin(3x) dx \right] = \frac{1}{\pi} \left[(-c) \left(-\frac{1}{3} \right) [\cos(3x)]_{-\pi}^0 + c \left(-\frac{1}{3} \right) [\cos(3x)]_0^{\pi} \right] \quad (\text{Integrating})$$

 **Result:** $b_3 = \frac{4c}{3\pi}$

Pattern: Even harmonics b_4, b_6, b_8 , etc., evaluate to 0.

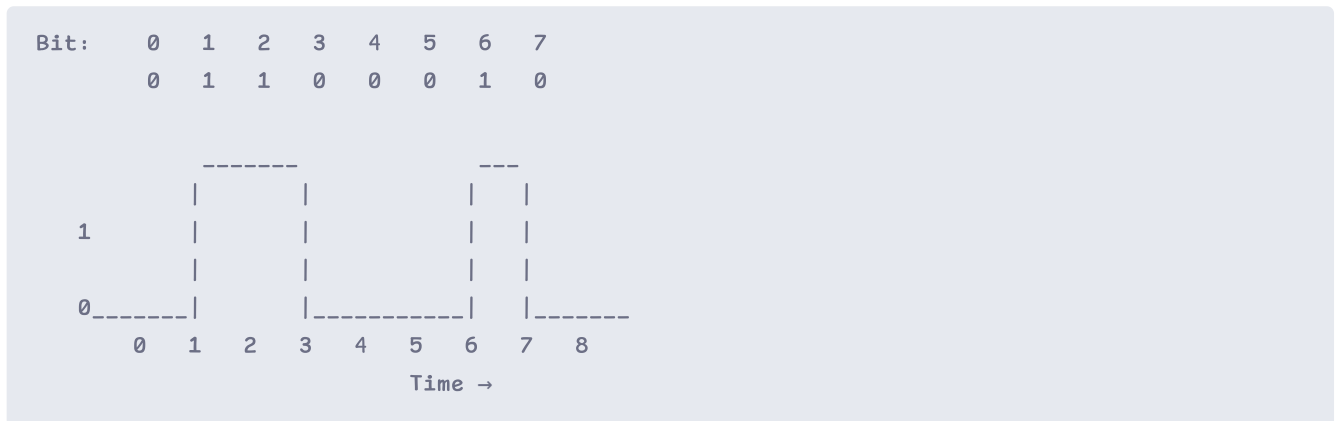
Resulting Series:

$$f(x) = \frac{4c}{\pi} \sin(x) + \frac{4c}{3\pi} \sin(3x) + \frac{4c}{5\pi} \sin(5x) + \frac{4c}{7\pi} \sin(7x) + \dots$$

Example 2: 8-bit ASCII "b"

Problem: Find the Fourier series representation of the 8-bit ASCII character "b" which translates to the binary signal 01100010.

Signal Waveform:



Answer:

Given:

- The period is $P = T = 8$.

Finding a_0 :

$$a_0 = \frac{1}{P} \int_0^T g(t) dt = \frac{1}{8} \left[\int_1^3 1 dt + \int_6^7 1 dt \right] = \frac{1}{8} (2 + 1) = \frac{3}{8}$$

Finding a_n :

$$a_n = \frac{2}{P} \int_0^T g(t) \cos\left(\frac{2\pi nt}{P}\right) dt = \frac{2}{8} \left[\int_1^3 \cos\left(\frac{\pi nt}{4}\right) dt + \int_6^7 \cos\left(\frac{\pi nt}{4}\right) dt \right] = \frac{1}{4} \cdot \frac{4}{\pi n} \left[\sin\left(\frac{3\pi n}{4}\right) - \sin\left(\frac{\pi n}{4}\right) + \sin\left(\frac{7\pi n}{4}\right) - \sin\left(\frac{6\pi n}{4}\right) \right]$$

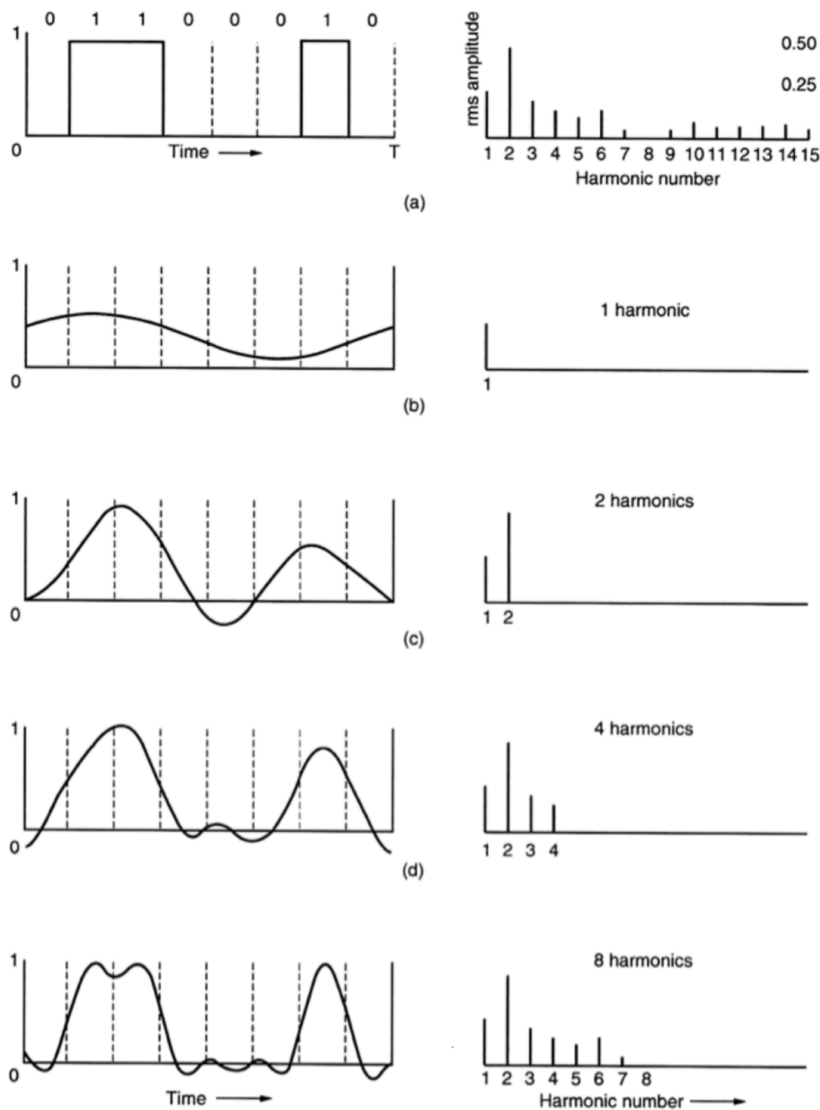
Finding b_n :

$$b_n = \frac{1}{\pi n} \left[\cos\left(\frac{\pi n}{4}\right) - \cos\left(\frac{3\pi n}{4}\right) + \cos\left(\frac{6\pi n}{4}\right) - \cos\left(\frac{7\pi n}{4}\right) \right]$$

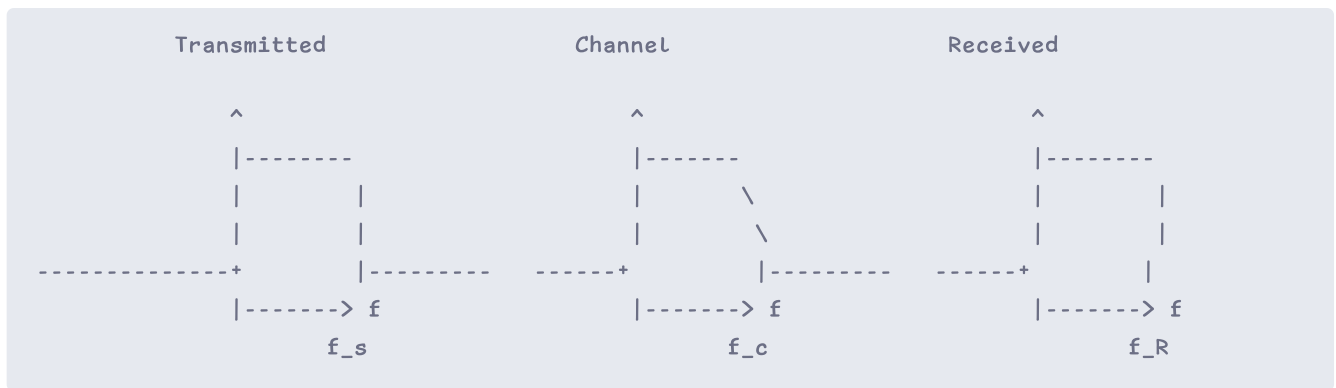
RMS & Harmonics

Root Mean Square Amplitude: The value $\sqrt{a_n^2 + b_n^2}$ is important because its square is proportional to the energy transmitted at the corresponding frequency.

Signal Approximation: Adding more harmonics (increasing n) makes the plotted series closer to the original signal.

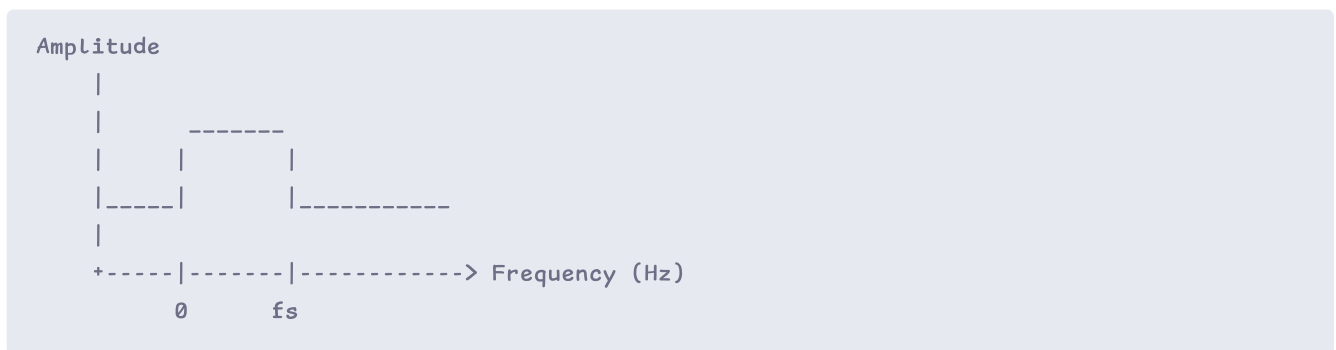


Signal Transmission Through Channel



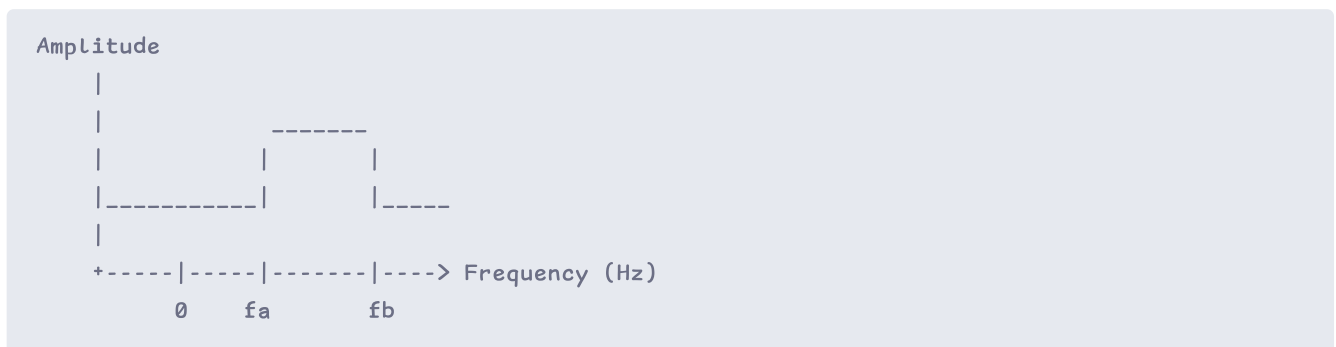
Two Types of Signals

Baseband Signal



Signal transmitted at original frequency, starting from 0 Hz

Passband Signal



Signal shifted to higher frequency band for transmission

Data Rate and Channel Harmonics

Signals can generally be classified as either baseband signals or passband signals.

Problem: Given a data rate of b bits/sec, how many harmonics can be transmitted through a voice-grade line with bandwidth 3000 Hz?

Answer:

Step 1: Calculate the time to send 8 bits:

$$T = \frac{8}{b} \text{ seconds}$$

Step 2: Calculate the frequency of the first harmonic:

$$f_1 = \frac{1}{T} = \frac{b}{8} \text{ Hz}$$

Step 3: Calculate the maximum number of harmonics in a 3 kHz bandwidth:

$$\text{Number of harmonics} = \frac{3000}{f_1} = \frac{3000}{b/8} = \frac{24000}{b}$$

Relation Between Data Rate and Harmonics

How is data rate related to harmonics?

Given a data rate of b bits/sec, the time required to send 8 bits is:

$$T = \frac{8}{b} \text{ seconds}$$

The frequency of the first harmonic (minimum) is:

$$f_1 = \frac{1}{T} = \frac{b}{8} \text{ Hz}$$

A voice-grade line has a bandwidth of 3000 Hz (3 kHz). This means that the largest number of harmonics that can be sent through is:

$$\text{Max harmonics} = \frac{3000}{f_1} = \frac{3000}{b/8} = \frac{24000}{b}$$

Example Calculation (300 bps):

$$T = \frac{8}{300} = 26.67 \text{ msec} \quad f_1 = \frac{300}{8} = 37.5 \text{ Hz} \quad \text{Max harmonics} = \frac{3000}{37.5} = 80$$

Bps	T (msec)	First harmonic (Hz)	# Harmonics sent
300	26.67	37.5	80
600	13.33	75	40
1200	6.67	150	20
2400	3.33	300	10

Bps	T (msec)	First harmonic (Hz)	# Harmonics sent
4800	1.67	600	5
9600	0.83	1200	2
19200	0.42	2400	1
38400	0.21	4800	0

Channel Capacity Theorems

Nyquist Capacity (1924, AT&T)

Defines the maximum data rate for a **noiseless channel**.

Formula:

$$\text{Maximum data rate} = 2B \log_2(V) \text{ bits/sec}$$

Variables:

- B = bandwidth in Hz
- V = number of discrete levels in the signal

Problem: What is the maximum data rate over a noiseless channel with a 3 kHz bandwidth using a binary (two levels) signal?

Answer:

$$\text{Maximum data rate} = 2B \log_2(V) = 2 \times 3000 \times \log_2(2) = 6000 \text{ bps}$$

Shannon Capacity (1948)

Defines the maximum data rate for a **noisy channel**.

Formula:

$$\text{Maximum data rate} = B \log_2(1 + \text{SNR}) \text{ bits/sec}$$

Signal-to-Noise Ratio (SNR):

- SNR is measured in decibels (dB)
- $\text{SNR}_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10}(\text{SNR})$
- **Example:** An SNR of 1000 equates to $10 \log_{10}(1000) = 30 \text{ dB}$

Problem: What is the line capacity of an ADSL line with a bandwidth of 1 MHz and an SNR of 40 dB?

Answer:

Step 1: Convert SNR from dB to linear scale:

$$40 = 10 \log_{10}(\text{SNR}) \quad \text{SNR} = 10^4 = 10000$$

Step 2: Calculate line capacity:

$$C = B \log_2(1 + \text{SNR}) = 10^6 \times \log_2(1 + 10000) = 10^6 \times \log_2(10001) \approx 10^6 \times 13.29 \approx 13 \text{ Mbps}$$